

CORE STORY (THE TRUTH OF THE MAZE)

The World

The hospital is **not a real hospital**.

It is a **mental containment space** — a liminal structure designed to hold people who refused to let go of their identities.

The corridors are endless because the mind is looping.

The maze exists to **test surrender**.

The Player

The player is **not a victim**.

The player is someone who:

- Refused treatment
- Refused to forget
- Refused to accept loss, guilt, or truth

So the system did not heal them.

It **contained** them.

Why the Hospital?

Hospitals are places of:

- Healing
- Control
- Observation
- Authority

This hospital is a **procedural therapy construct**:

- Endless corridors = unresolved thoughts
- Locked doors = denied acceptance
- Teleport traps = avoidance, dissociation

The maze rearranges because the mind does.

Why the Masks Exist

The masks are **coping mechanisms**.

They are not gifts.

They are **shortcuts the system allows** — but only once.

Each mask removes part of the player's identity.

That's why they're one-time use.

THE MASKS (STORY MEANING)



MASK 1 — THE PATH MASK

What it Represents: Obsession with answers

“If I just knew the way out.”

The system allows the player to see the exit briefly —
because people often believe **knowledge alone will save them**.

But knowing the path doesn't mean you can walk it.

MASK 2 — (Story Role, Flexible Mechanic)

Let's define it **narratively**, regardless of final mechanic.

Theme: Avoidance / Control / Memory / Silence

This mask represents:

"If I don't face it directly, it can't hurt me."

It allows the player to bypass discomfort —
but at the cost of becoming more lost later.

MASK 3 — THE REVELATION MASK (Unlocked at Portal)

This is the most important one narratively.

It unlocks only after the player reaches the portal because:

You can't face the truth until you believe you're free.

Seeing through walls = seeing reality as it is.

And what does that reveal?

That escape was **never just the portal**.

Why the Player Needs to Escape

The player believes they are escaping the maze.

In reality, they are escaping **treatment**.

The system is trying to:

- Break their coping mechanisms
- Force acceptance

- Strip away false identities

Escaping means:

Leaving without healing.

That's why escape is possible — but costly.

THE PORTAL TWIST (VERY IMPORTANT)

When the player reaches the portal:

- It looks final
- It looks like freedom
- It is locked

Because the system never intended escape to be easy.

The key is hidden because:

You must see the truth to leave — not just want to leave.

That's why the **third mask unlocks here**.

THE KEY (SYMBOLISM)

The key is not a literal object.

It represents:

- Acceptance
- Awareness
- Letting go

That's why it's:

- Hidden
- Visible only briefly
- Easy to miss
- Stressful to retrieve

ENDING (MINIMAL, STRONG)

When the player escapes:

No celebration.

No music swell.

No victory screen.

Just one line:

“DISCHARGED”

Or:

“PATIENT RELEASED — CONDITION: UNSTABLE”

Or:

“YOU MAY LEAVE. YOU ARE NOT CURED.”